Settlement Officer at Raipur where in five years he successfully carried out one of the heaviest settlement operations undertaken till then.

In 1930, Deshmukh received a letter asking him if he would be willing to become one of the three Secretaries of the Second Round Table Conference to be held in September-October that year. Deshmukh agreed and was assigned to the Federal Structure Sub-committee where his duty was to summarize the day's deliberations from day to day. He took his own notes, and twice each day, before lunch for the morning session, and before leaving for home for the afternoon session, dictated summaries of about ten pages each which were circulated in the evening to all the members. The British Prime Minister, Ramsay MacDonald, expressed his appreciation of this efficiency and wanted to know to whom the credit was due. Deshmukh's efforts were acknowledged by Archibald Carter, the Secretary General of the Conference, by way of a demi-official letter. This assignment gave Deshmukh the opportunity of meeting many important Indian leaders, including Gandhi, who was the sole representative of the Congress.

On his return from England, Deshmukh was posted as temporary Revenue Secretary to the Government in a leave vacancy. His most important contribution in this post was his assistance in framing and enactment of the Debt Conciliation Act—the first legislation of its kind in India, whose aim was to implement one of the major recommendations of the Linlithgow Agricultural Commission. At that time, there was a Legislative Council which included some nominated members, principally officials. Deshmukh was one of those nominated and assisted his Revenue Member, Sir Hyde Gowan, during the passage of the Bill. In 1934, Deshmukh became Finance Secretary to the CP and Berar government, and in 1939 joined the Department of Education, Health and Lands at the Centre. Soon after, he joined the RBI, rising to become its first Indian Governor, details of which are narrated in Chapter 17.

Like Purshotamdas, Deshmukh too was a multi-faceted personality, in fact, much more so. Among his most noteworthy contributions was his representation of the Indian case at Bretton Woods. He was a member of the Board of Governors of both the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank for ten years and was the Chairman of the joint meetings of these two institutions held in Paris in 1950. In September 1949, soon after his extended tenure at the RBI ended, he was appointed as India's special